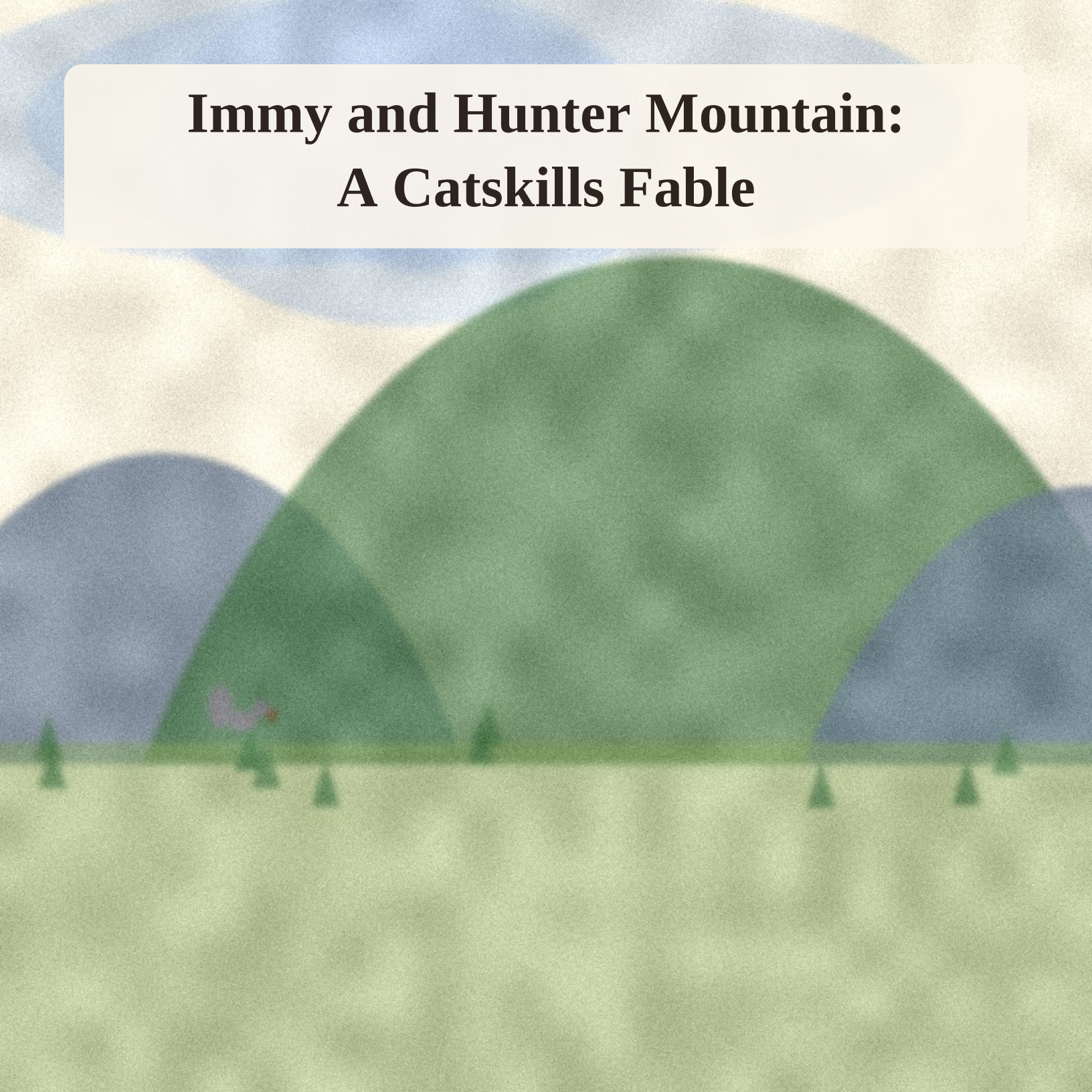
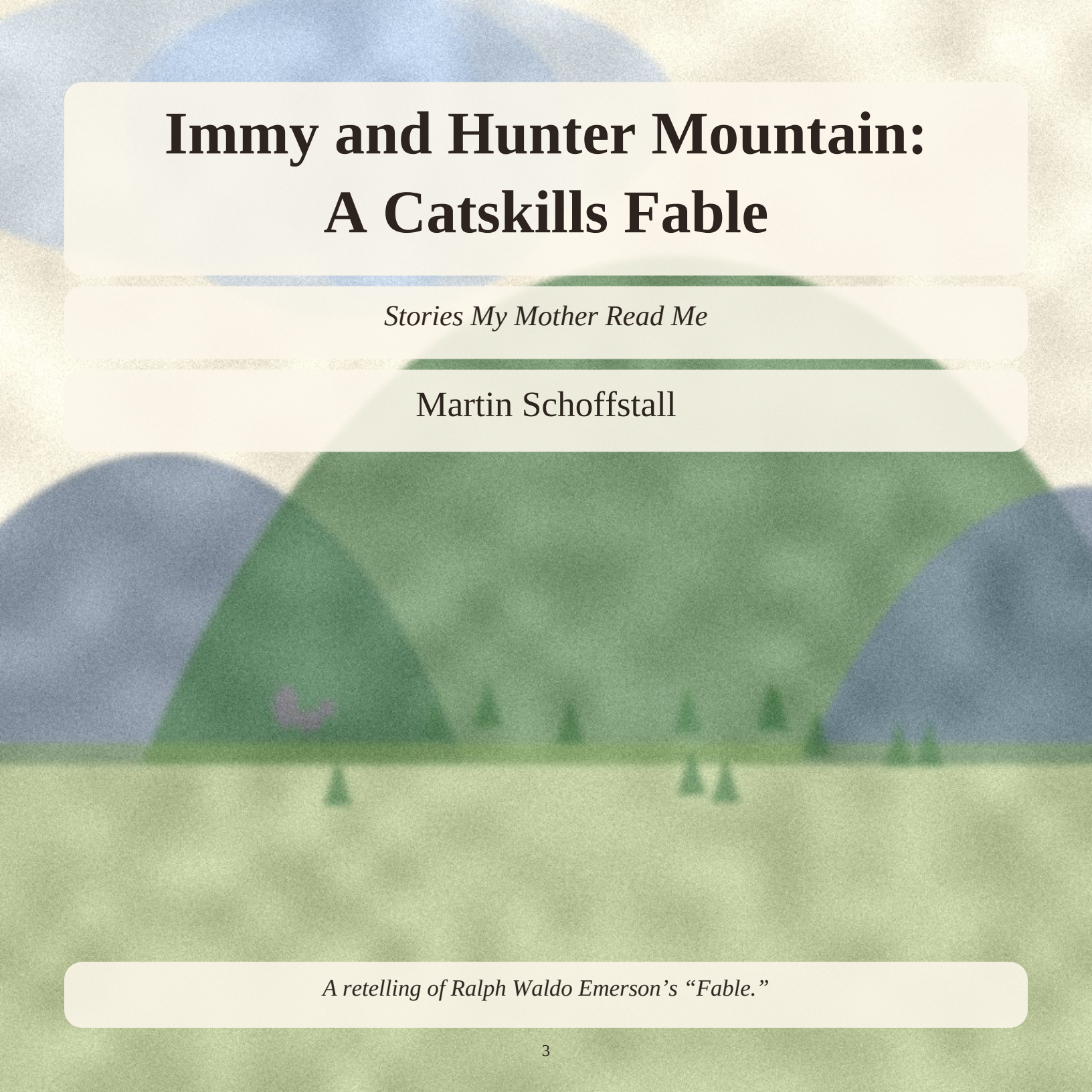
Immy and Hunter Mountain: A Catskills Fable



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Adapted from Ralph Waldo Emerson’s “Fable” (Poems, 1847), later anthologized as “The Mountain and the Squirrel.” Emerson’s poem is in the public domain; text per the Academy of American Poets and the Poetry Foundation.
Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB): Psalm 139:14 and 1 Corinthians 12:18-20.
Stories My Mother Read Me: Fern and the High Grapes · The Missing Church Tulips · Immy and Hunter Mountain: A Catskills Fable.

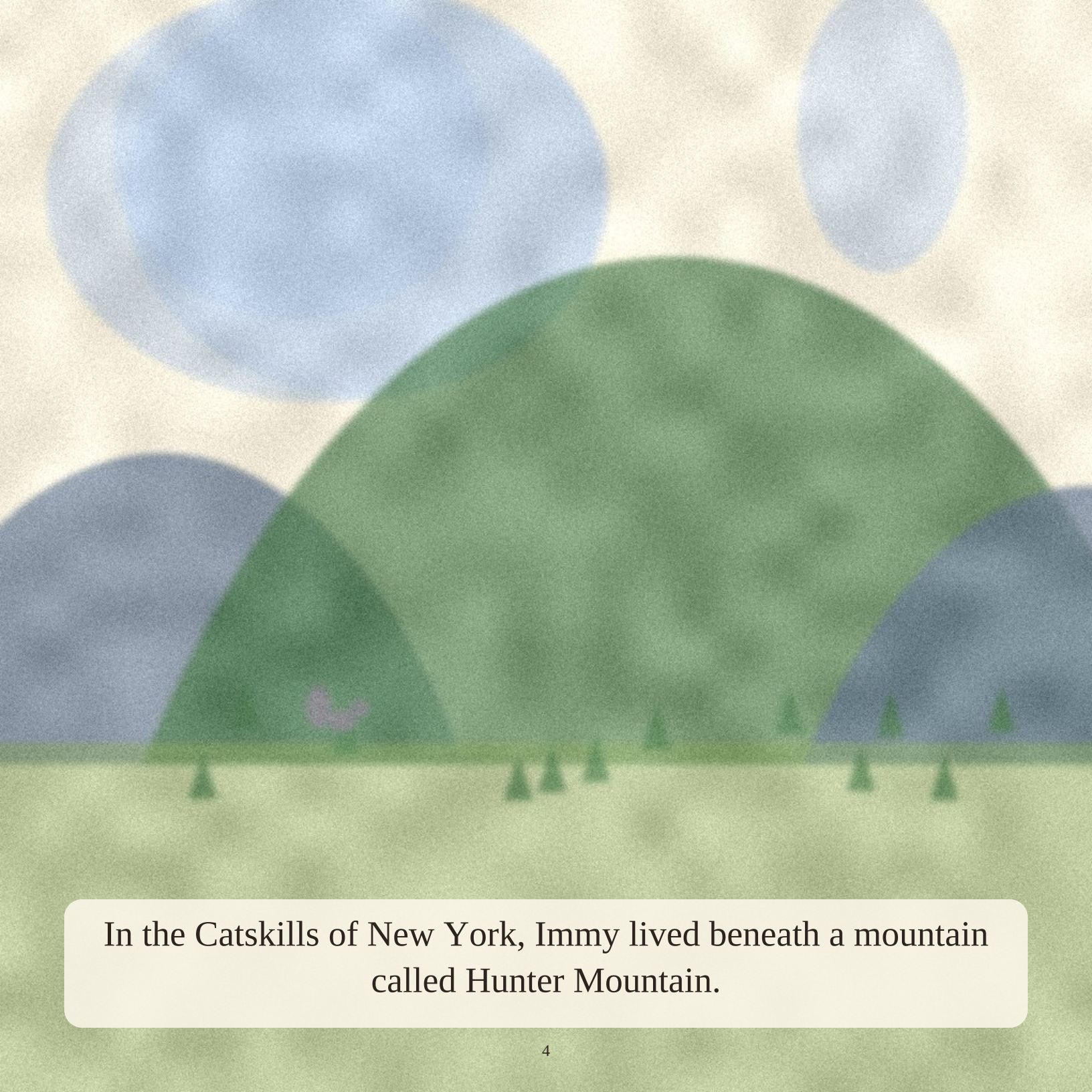


Immy and Hunter Mountain: A Catskills Fable

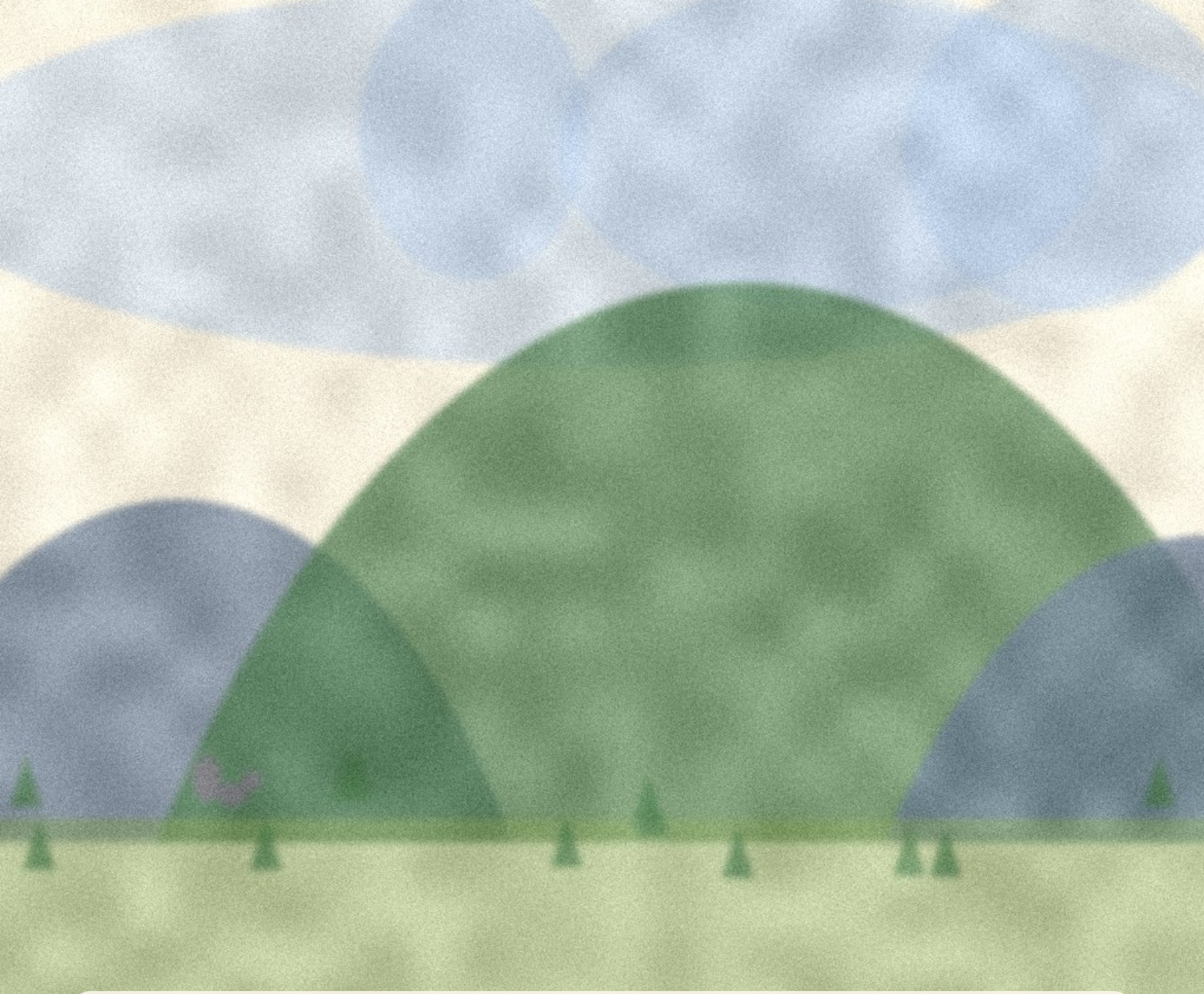
Stories My Mother Read Me

Martin Schoffstall

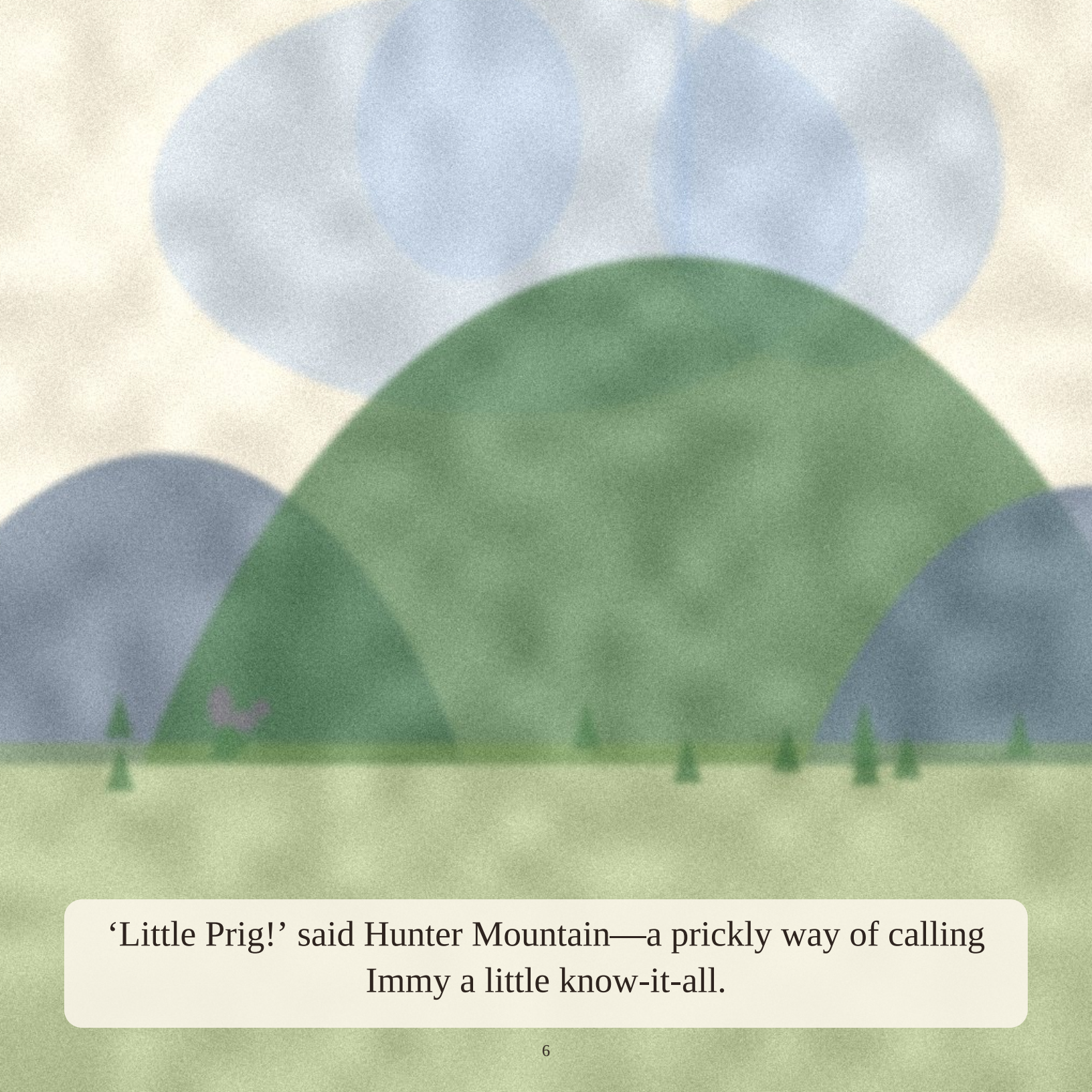
A retelling of Ralph Waldo Emerson's "Fable."



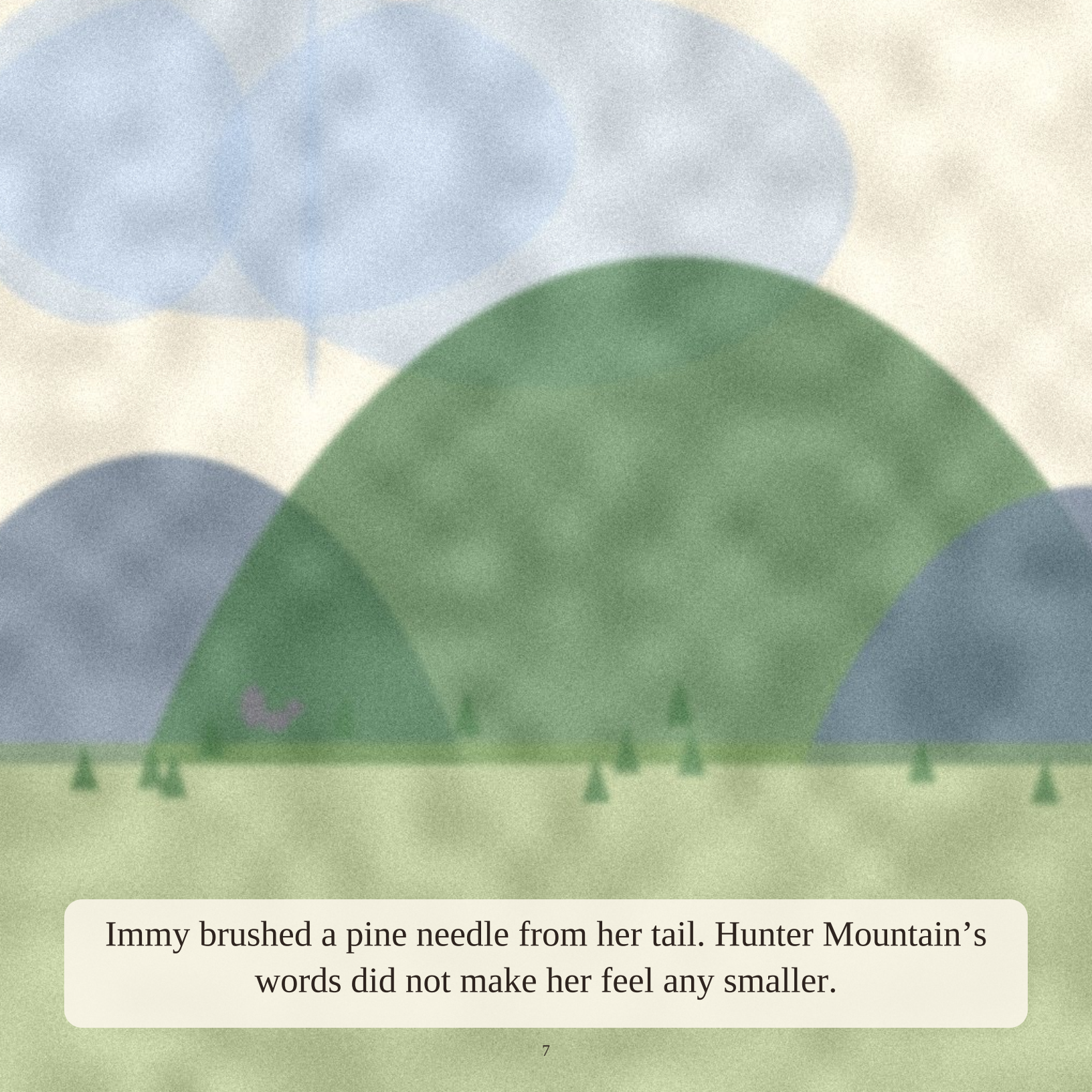
In the Catskills of New York, Immy lived beneath a mountain called Hunter Mountain.



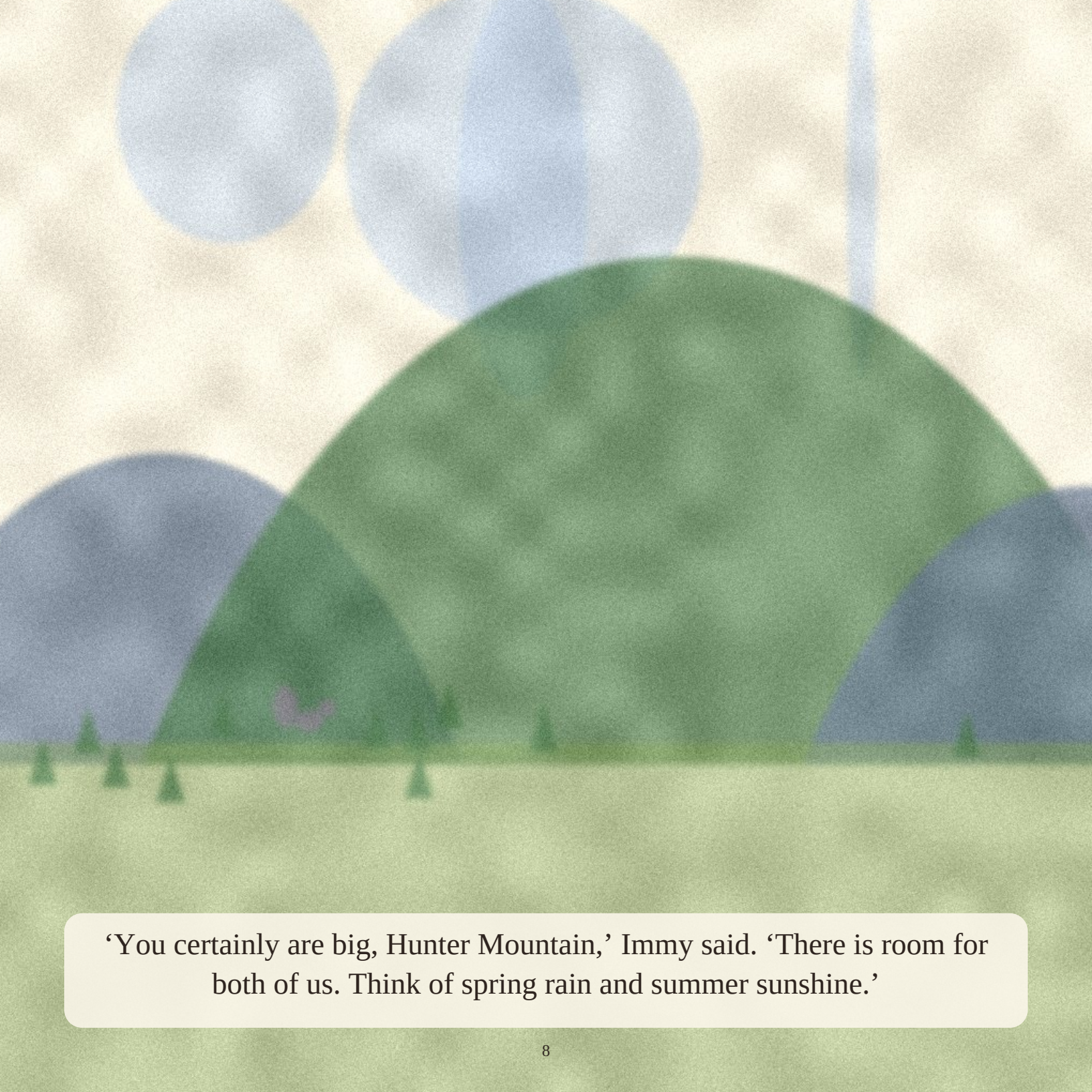
‘I am Hunter Mountain,’ the mountain boomed. ‘Look how high I rise!’



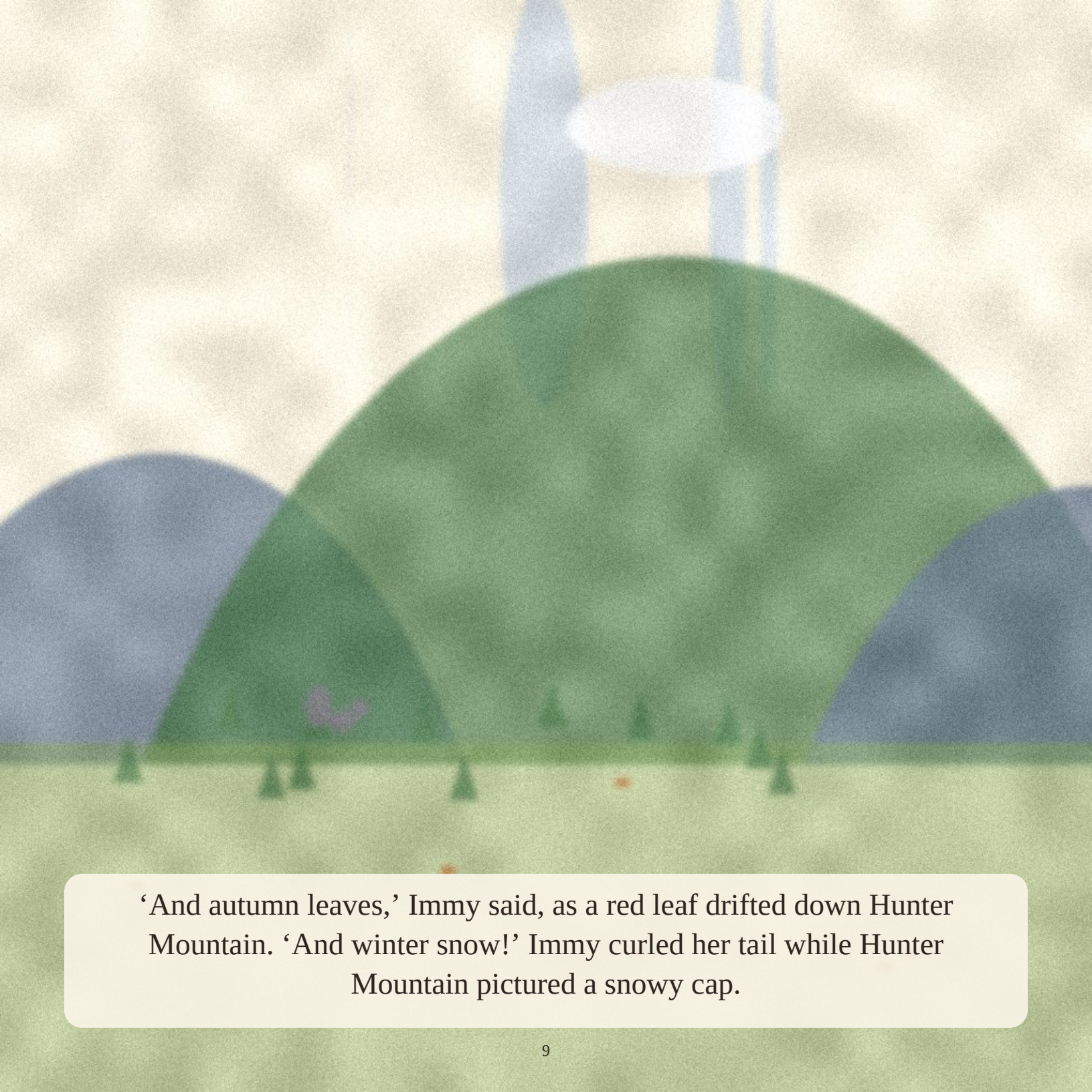
‘Little Prig!’ said Hunter Mountain—a prickly way of calling Immy a little know-it-all.



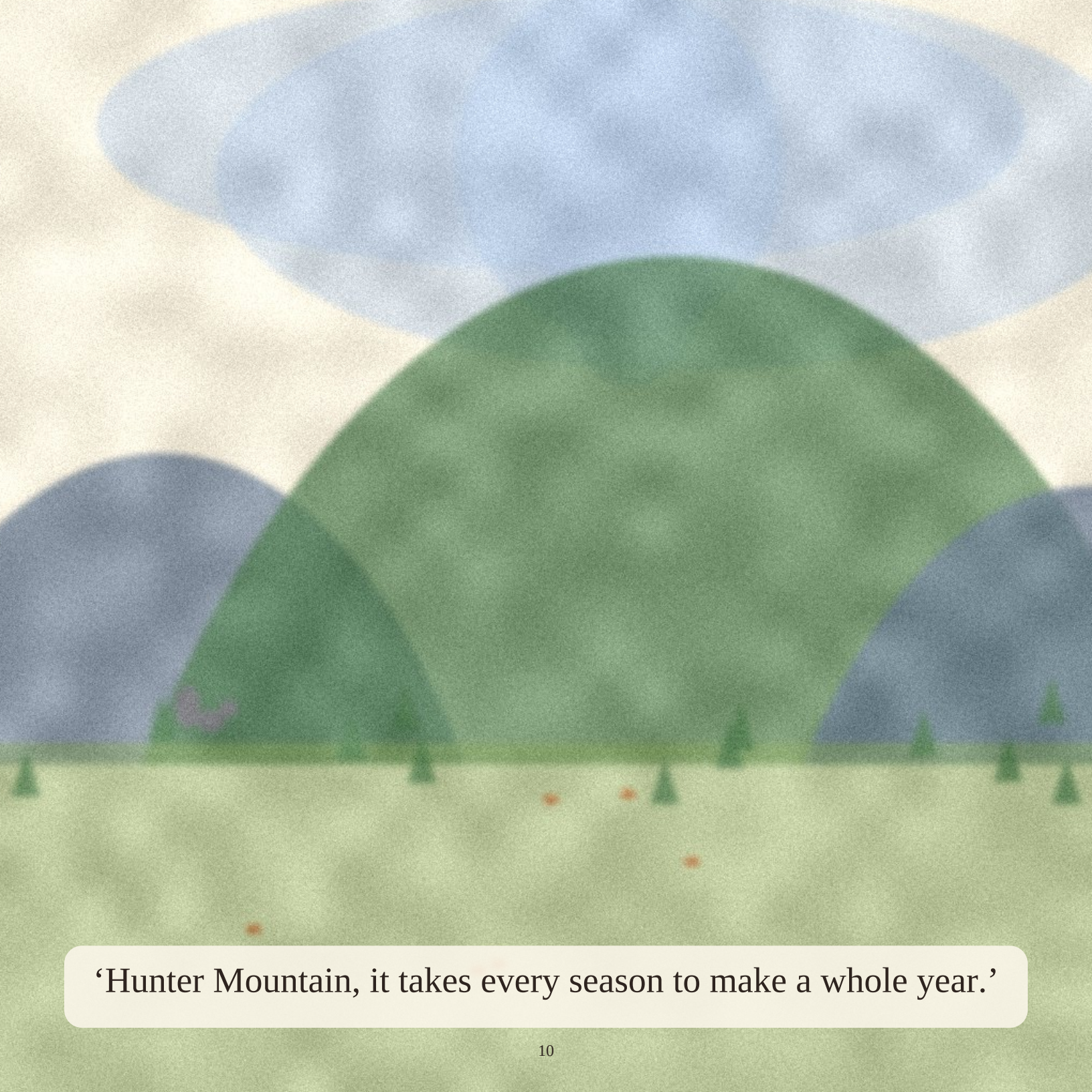
Immy brushed a pine needle from her tail. Hunter Mountain’s words did not make her feel any smaller.



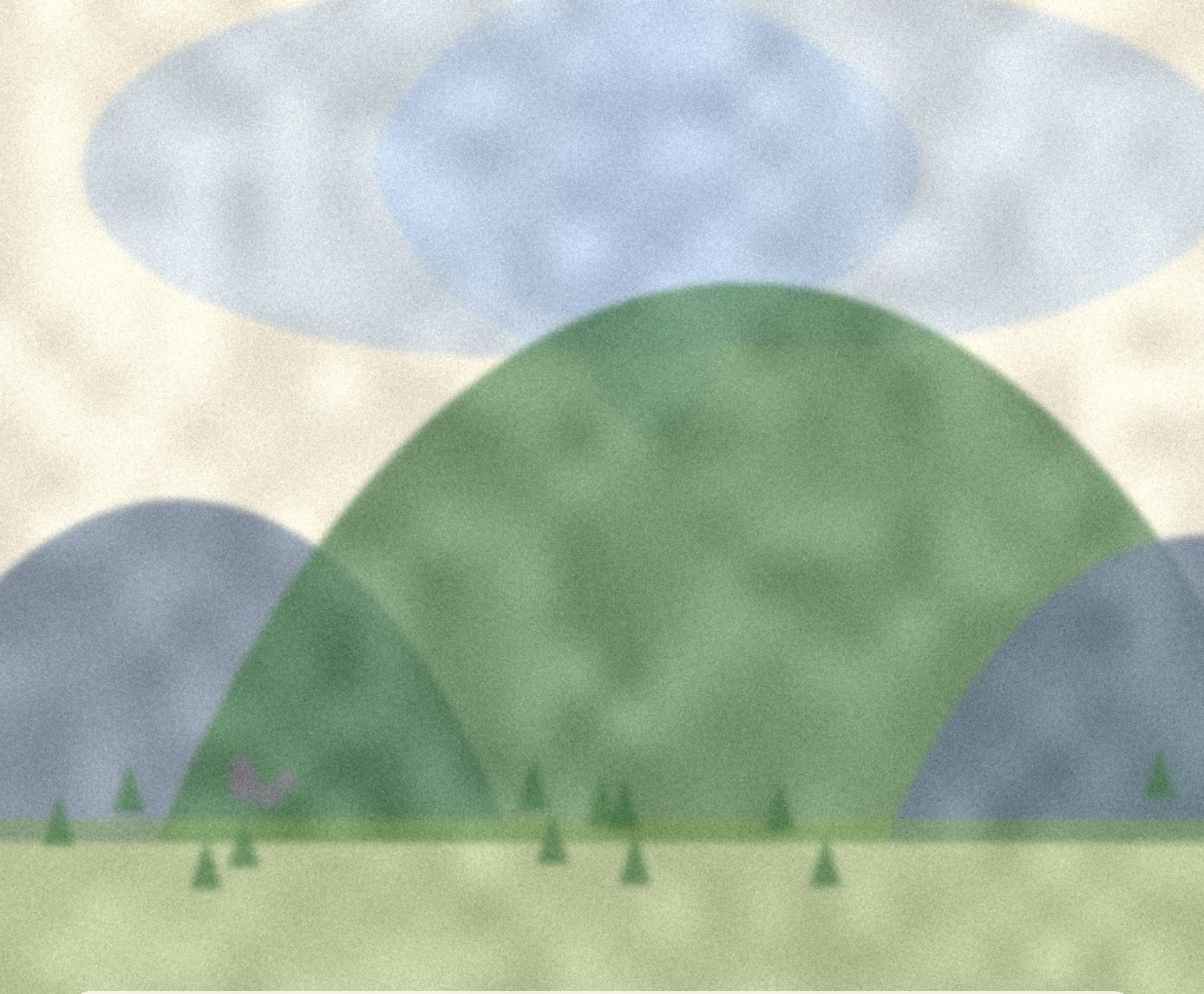
‘You certainly are big, Hunter Mountain,’ Immy said. ‘There is room for both of us. Think of spring rain and summer sunshine.’



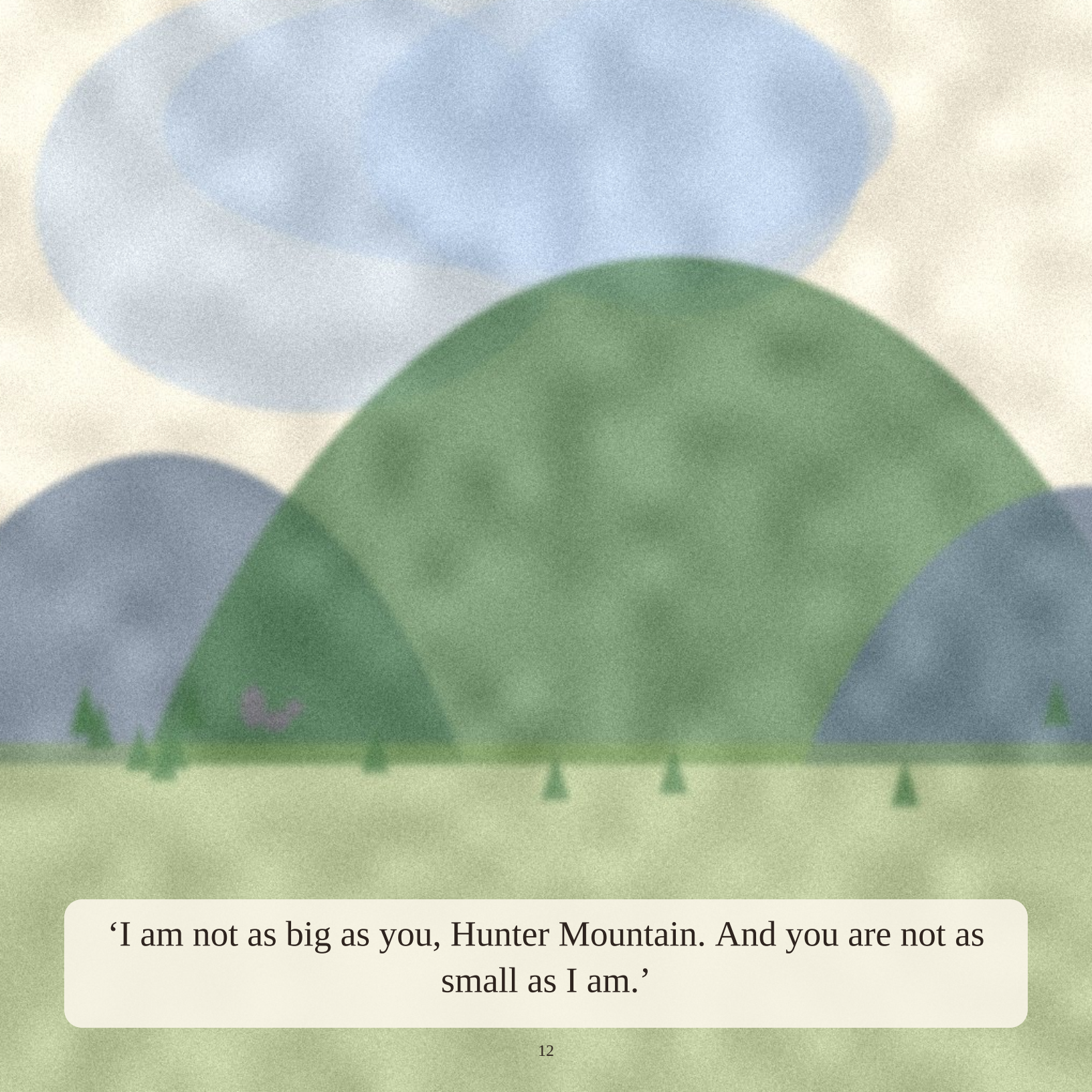
‘And autumn leaves,’ Immy said, as a red leaf drifted down Hunter Mountain. ‘And winter snow!’ Immy curled her tail while Hunter Mountain pictured a snowy cap.



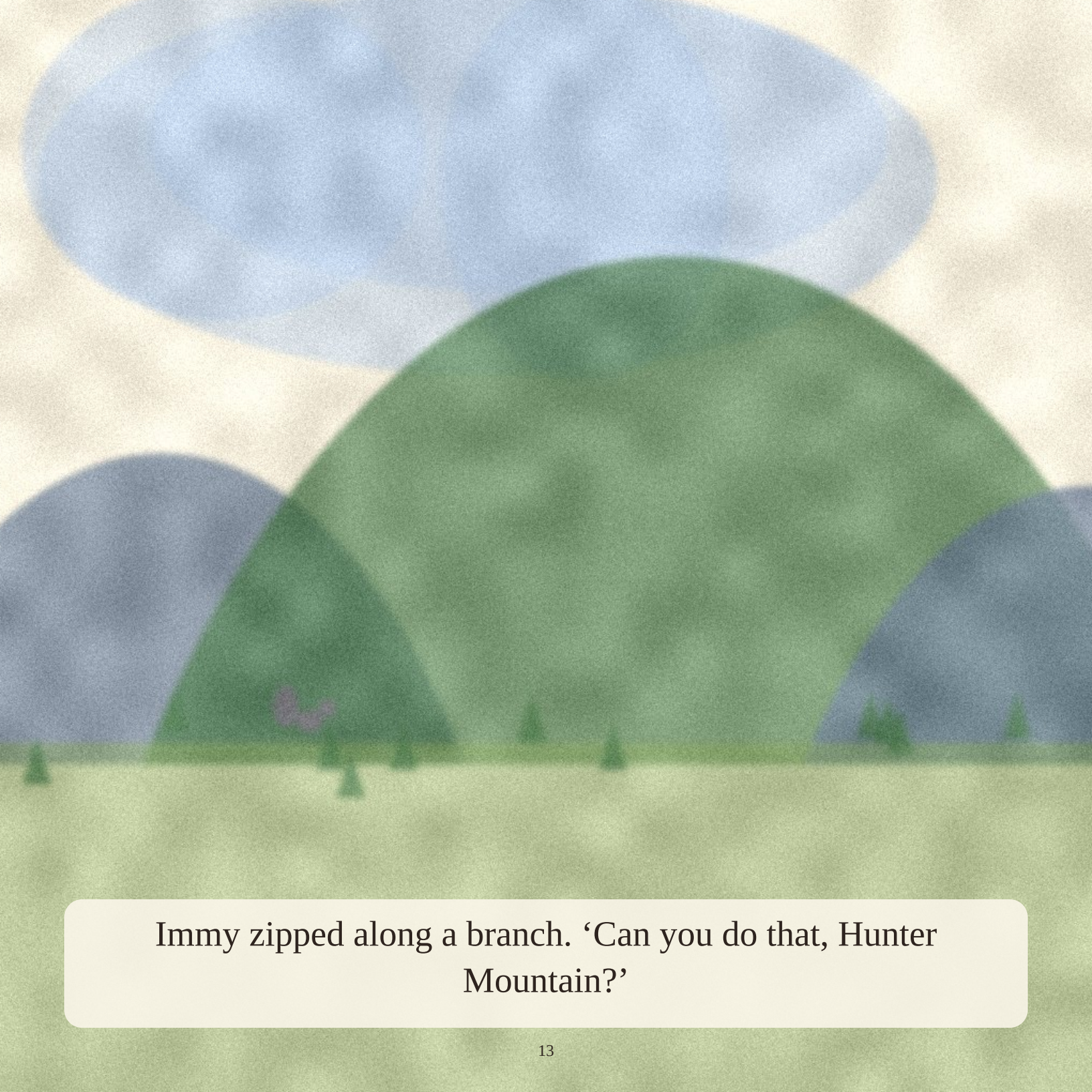
‘Hunter Mountain, it takes every season to make a whole year.’



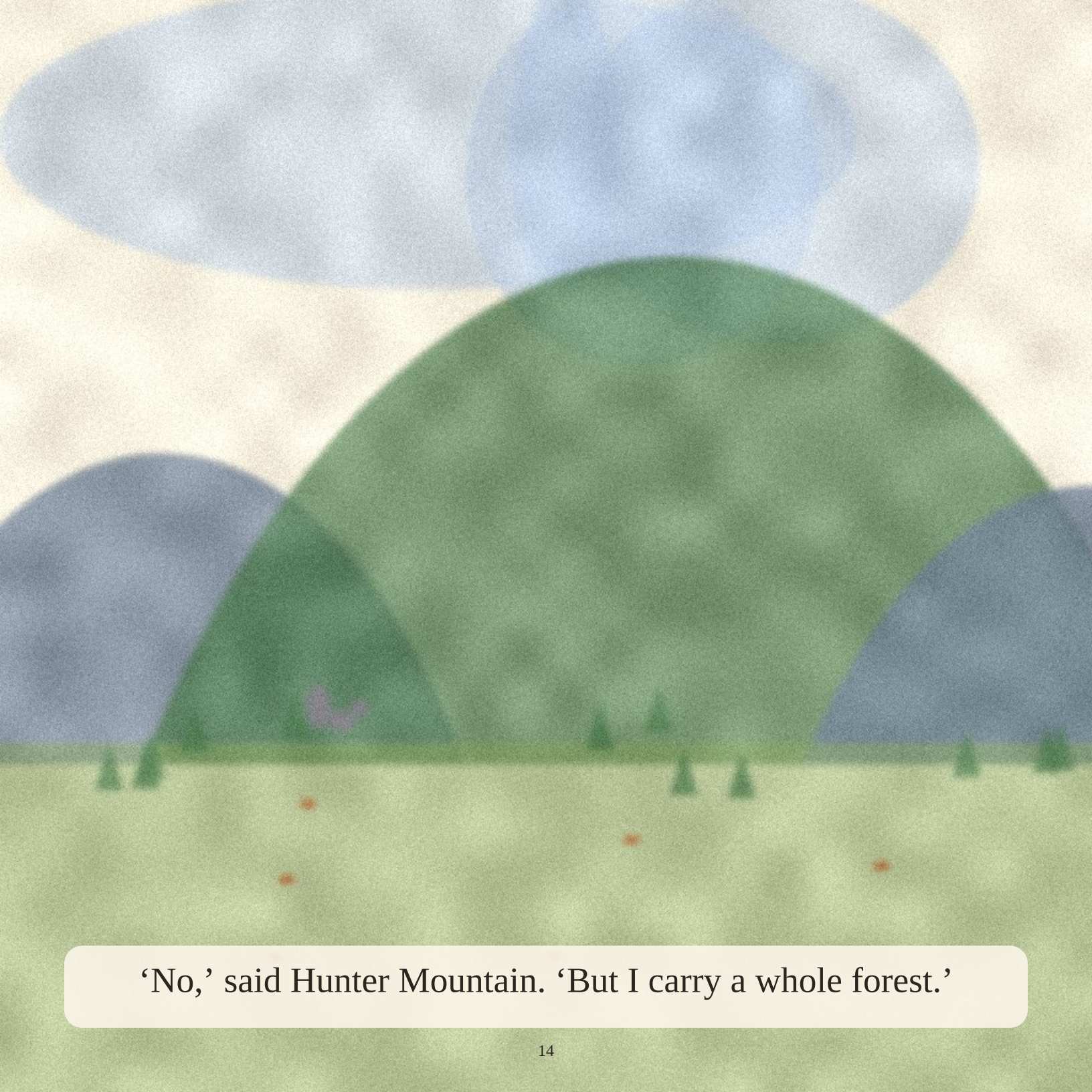
‘God made a place for small creatures, too,’ Immy told Hunter Mountain.



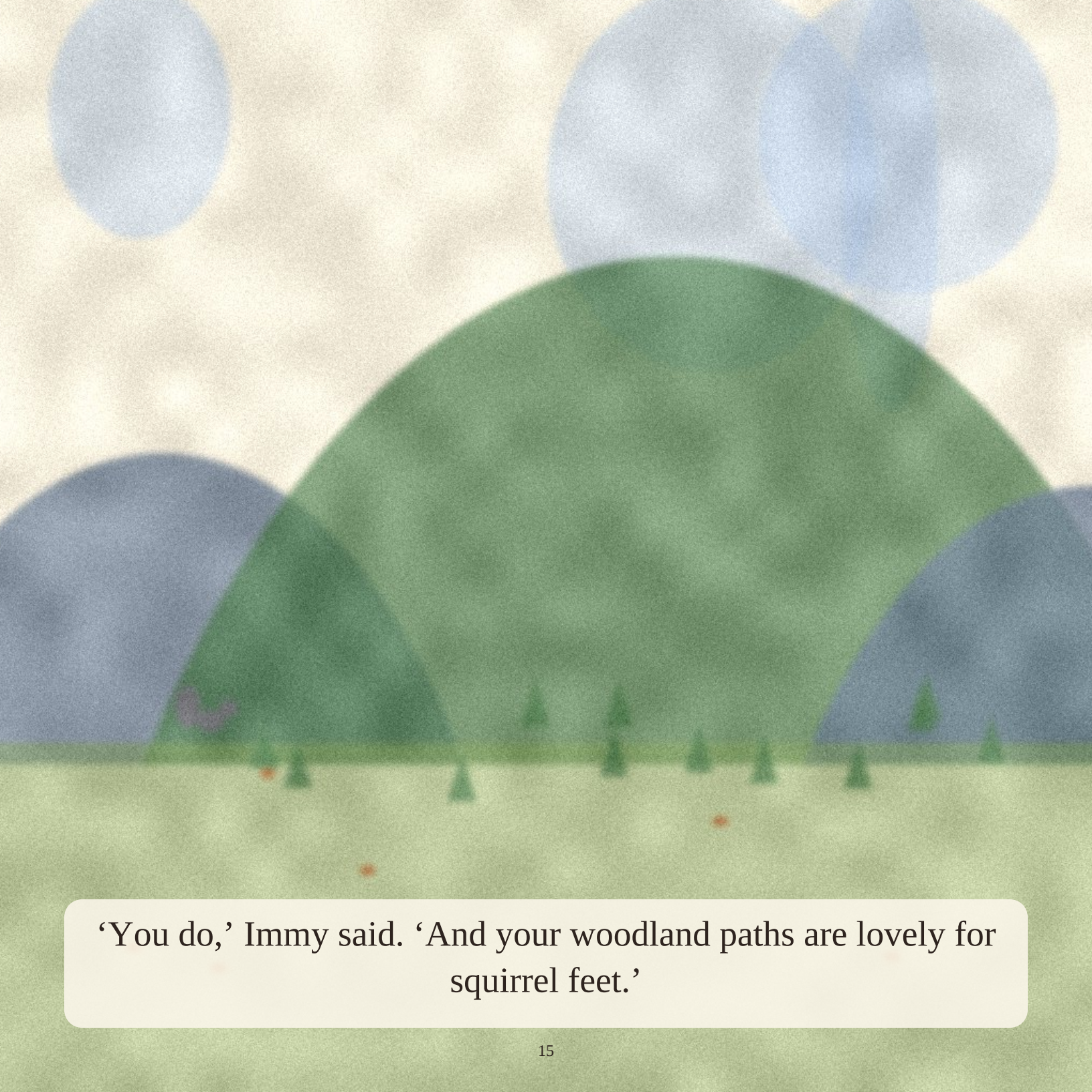
‘I am not as big as you, Hunter Mountain. And you are not as small as I am.’



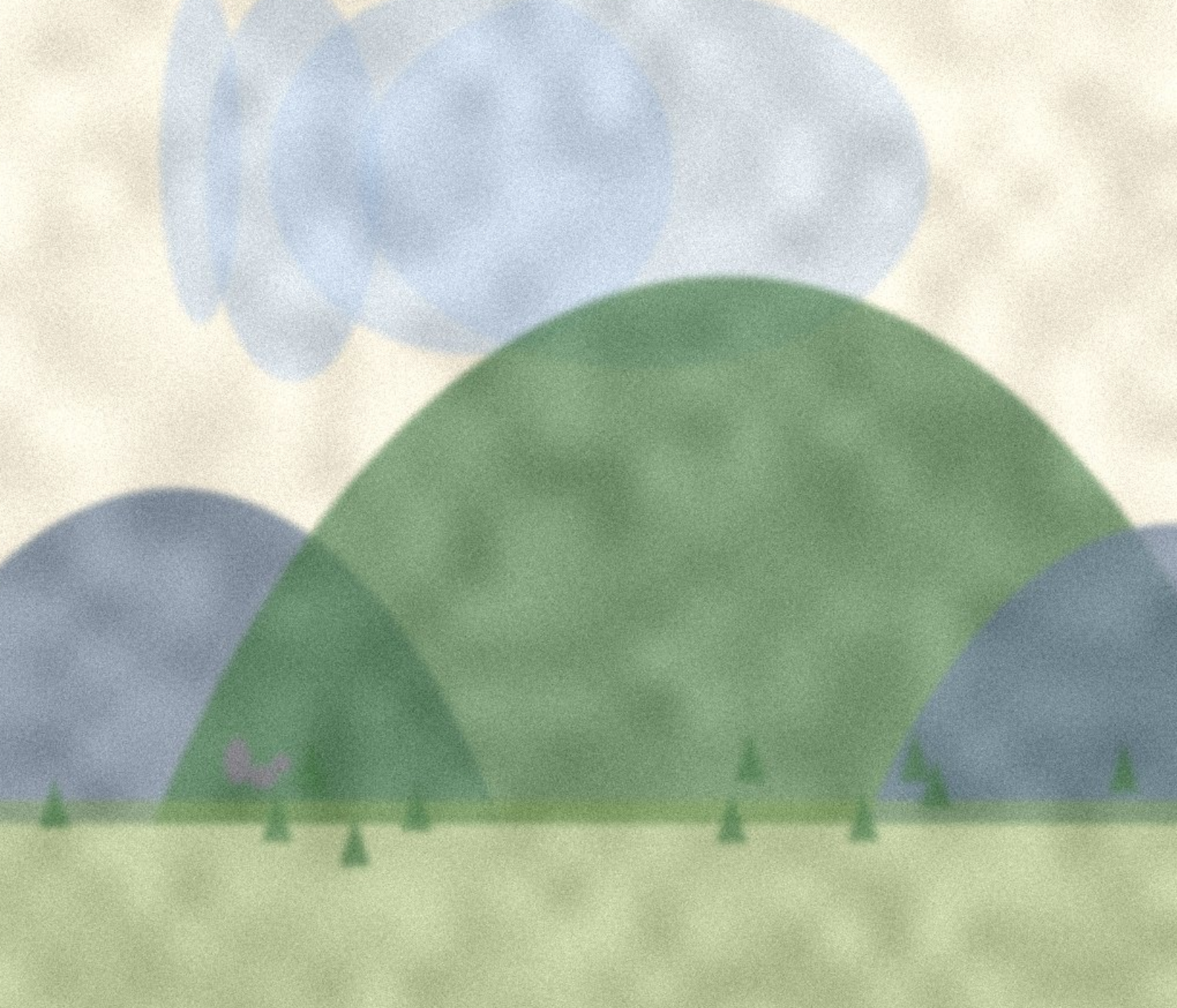
Immy zipped along a branch. ‘Can you do that, Hunter Mountain?’



‘No,’ said Hunter Mountain. ‘But I carry a whole forest.’



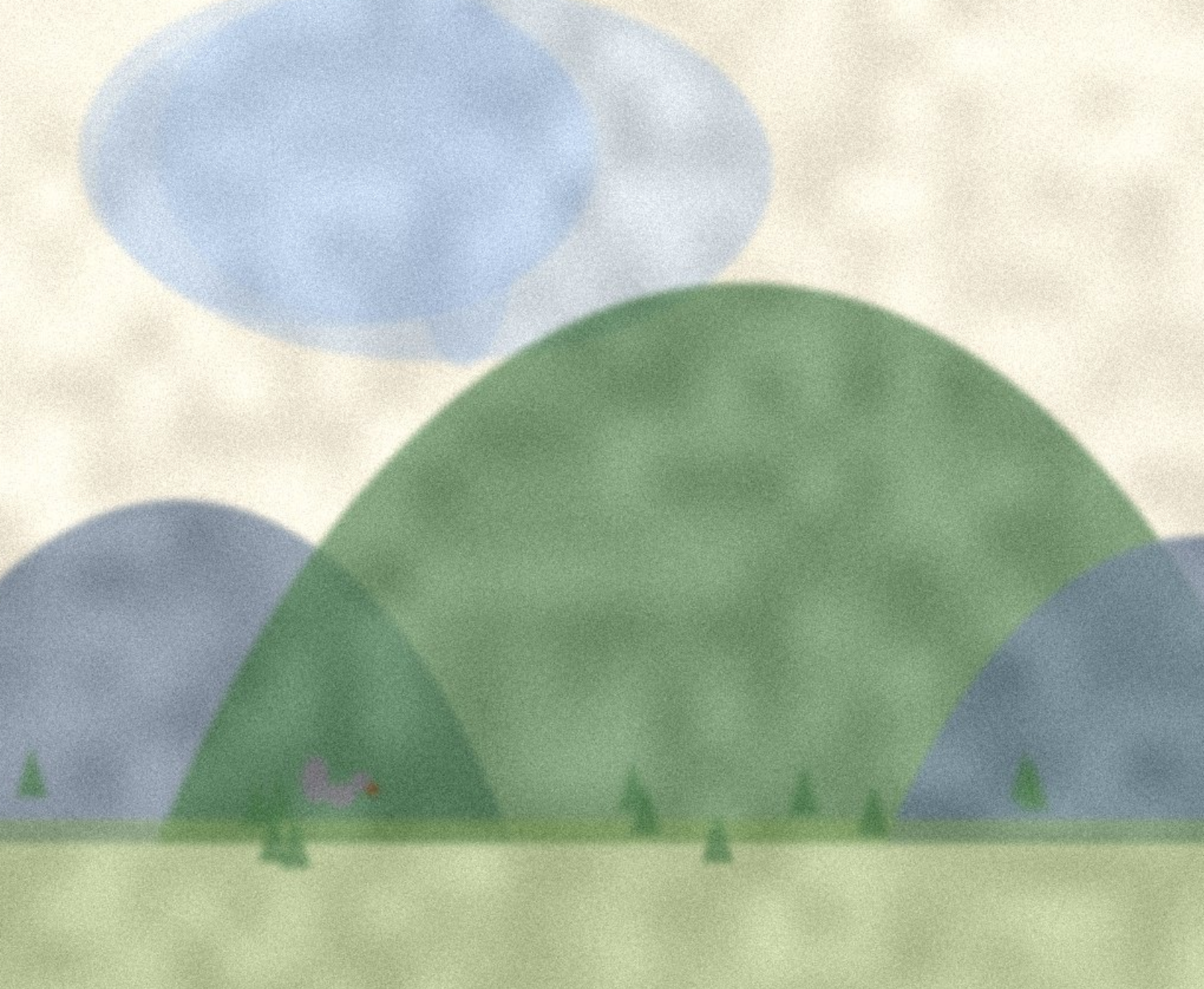
‘You do,’ Immy said. ‘And your woodland paths are lovely for squirrel feet.’



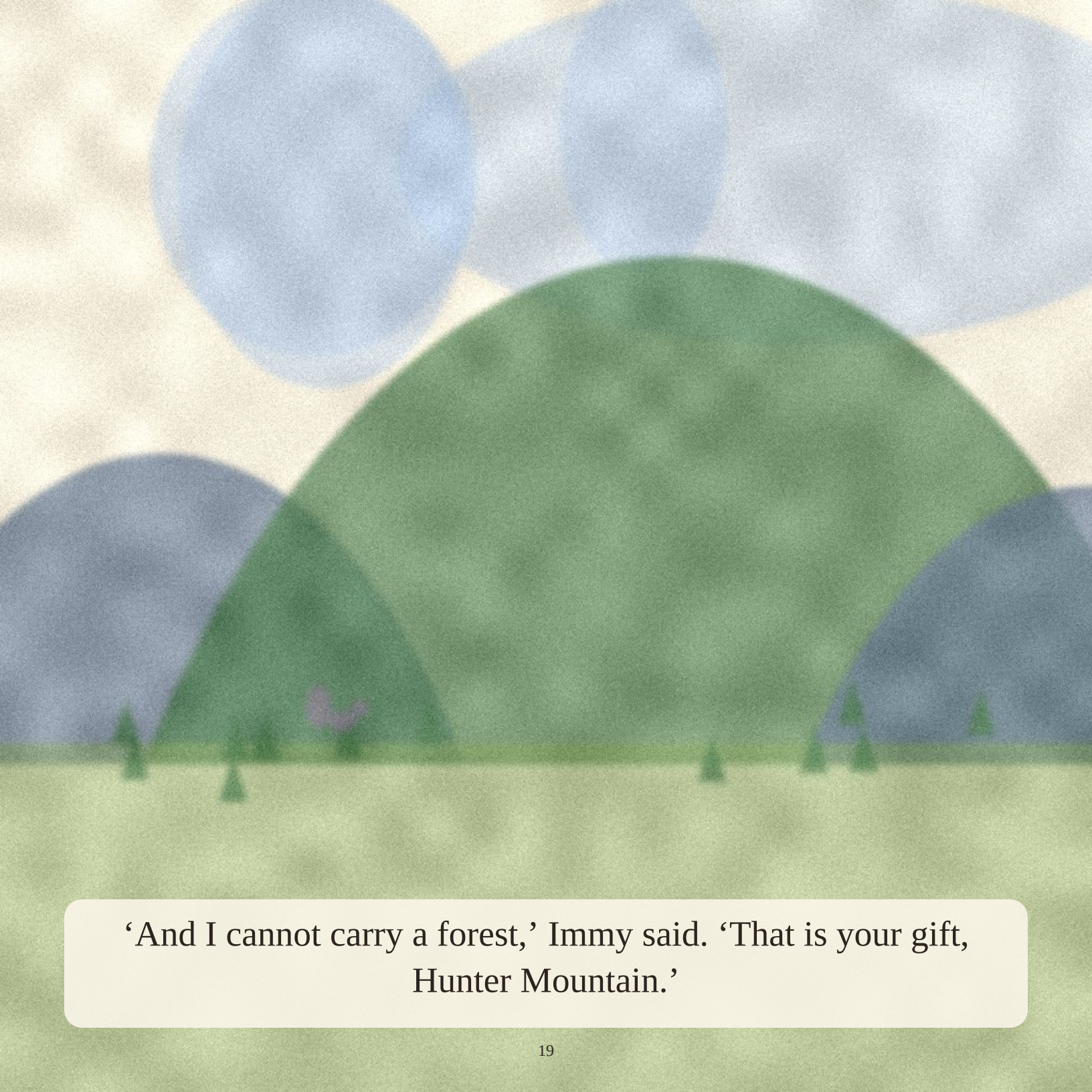
‘Thank you, Immy,’ Hunter Mountain said, a little more softly.



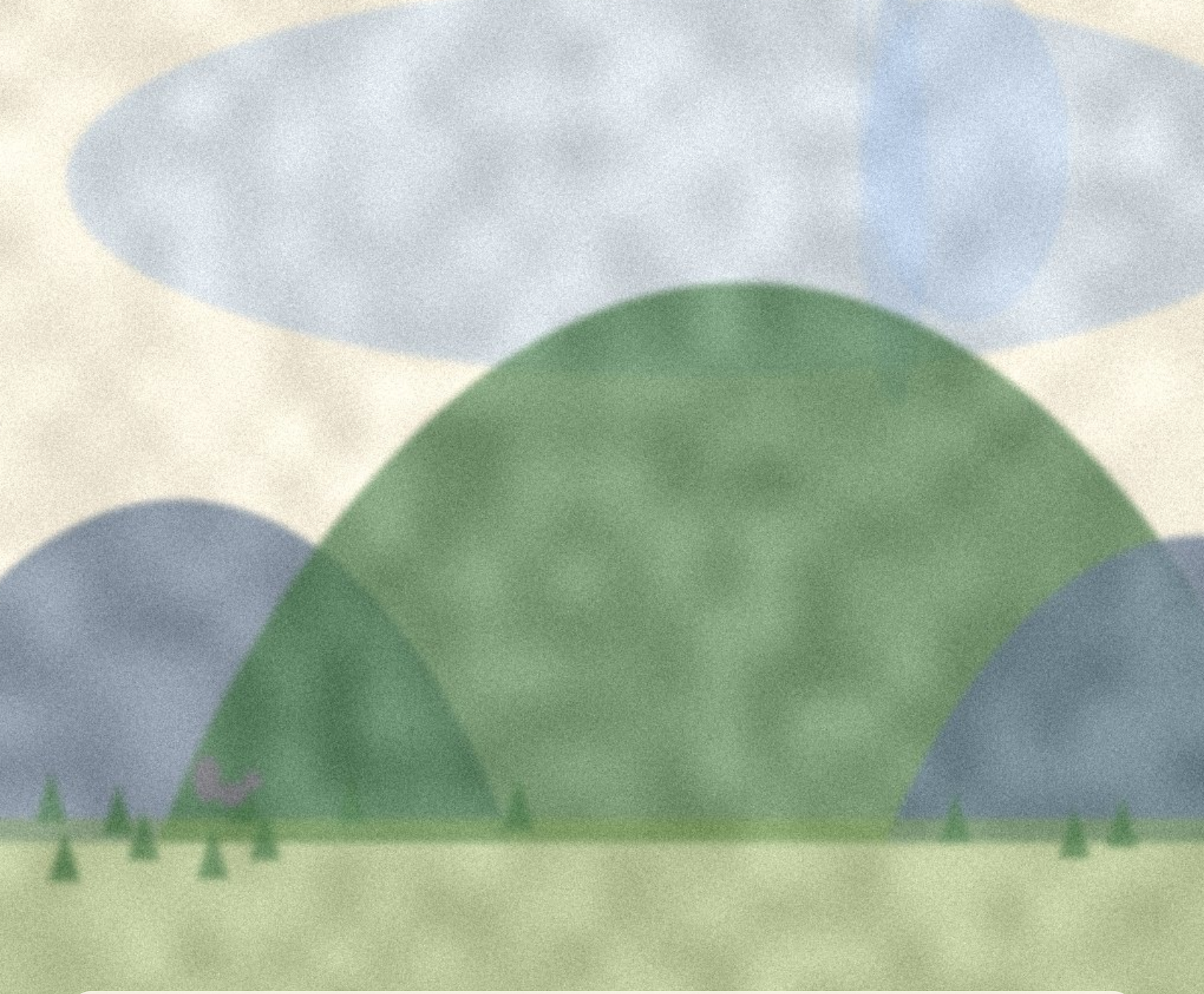
Immy lifted a nut. ‘Hunter Mountain, can you crack this?’



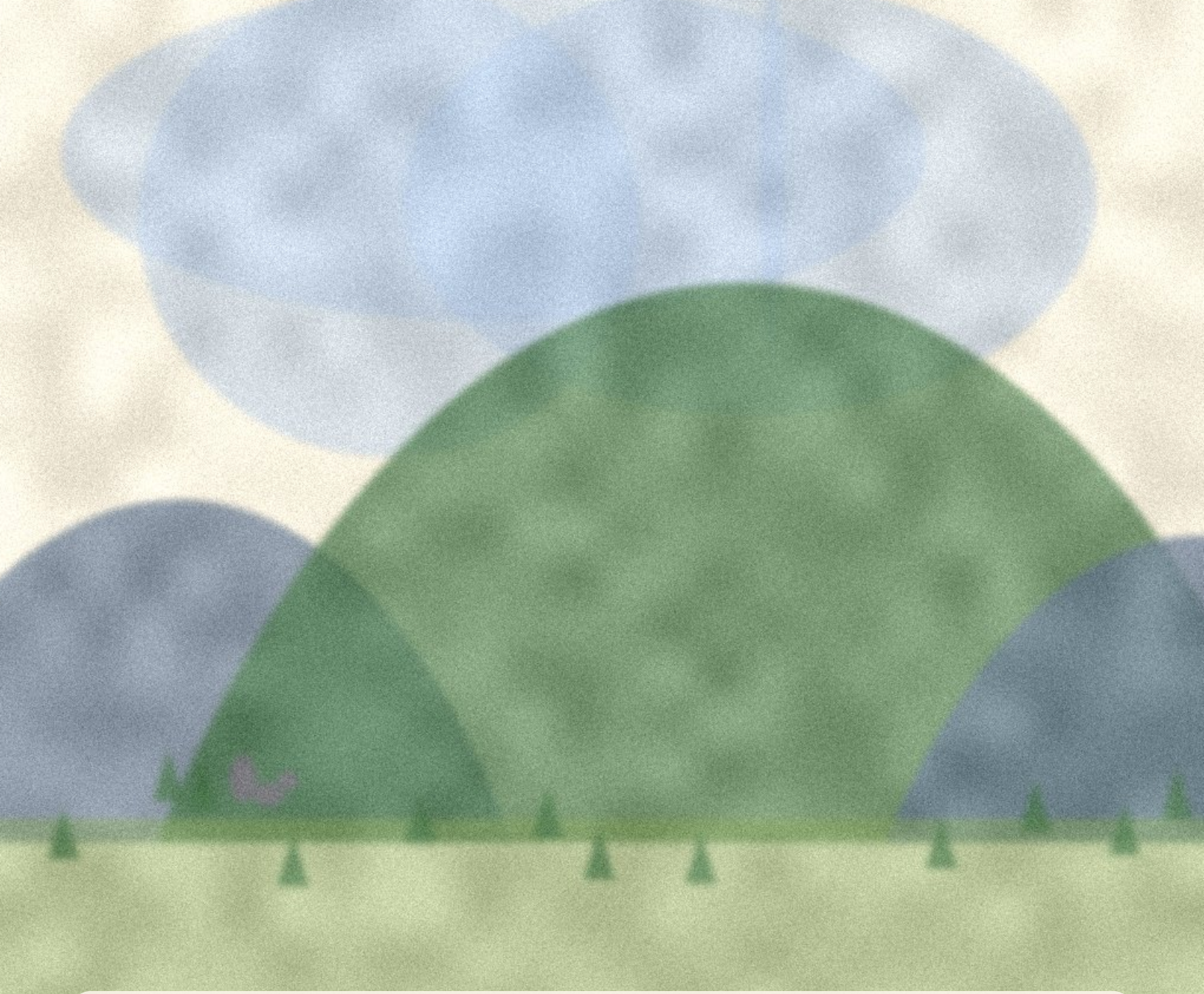
‘I cannot,’ admitted Hunter Mountain. Crack! Immy opened the shell.



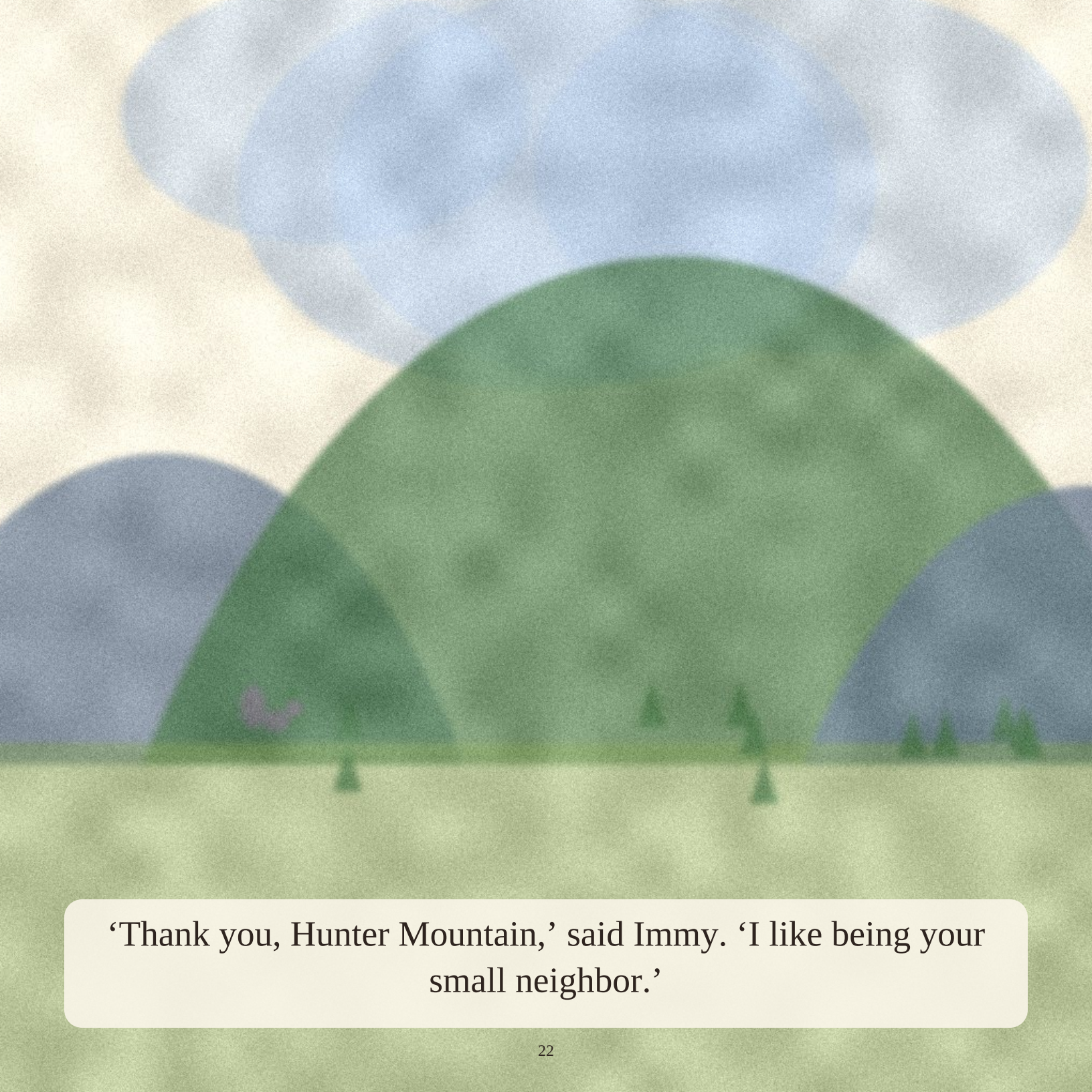
‘And I cannot carry a forest,’ Immy said. ‘That is your gift, Hunter Mountain.’



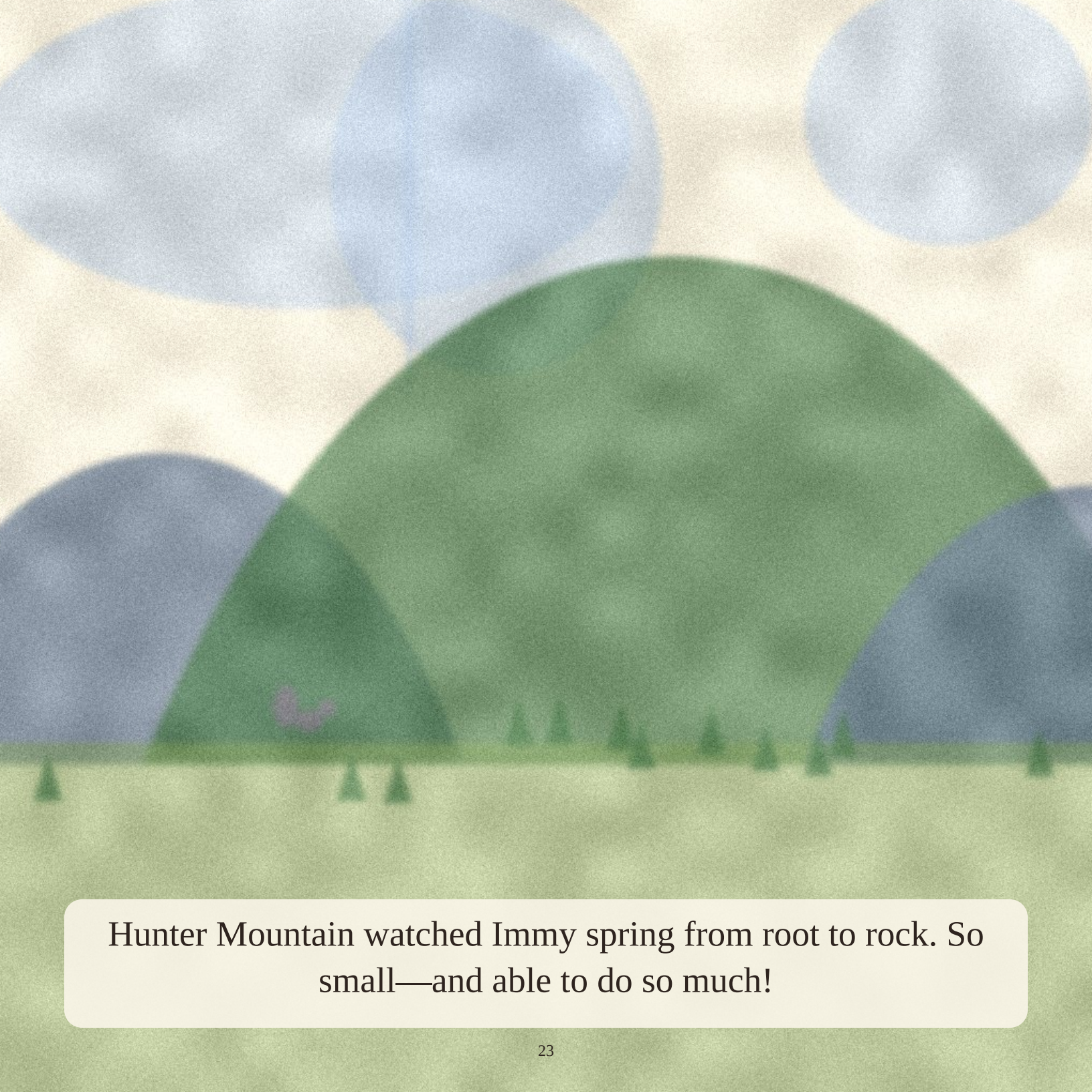
‘God gave us different gifts,’ Immy told Hunter Mountain. ‘We can be glad for both.’



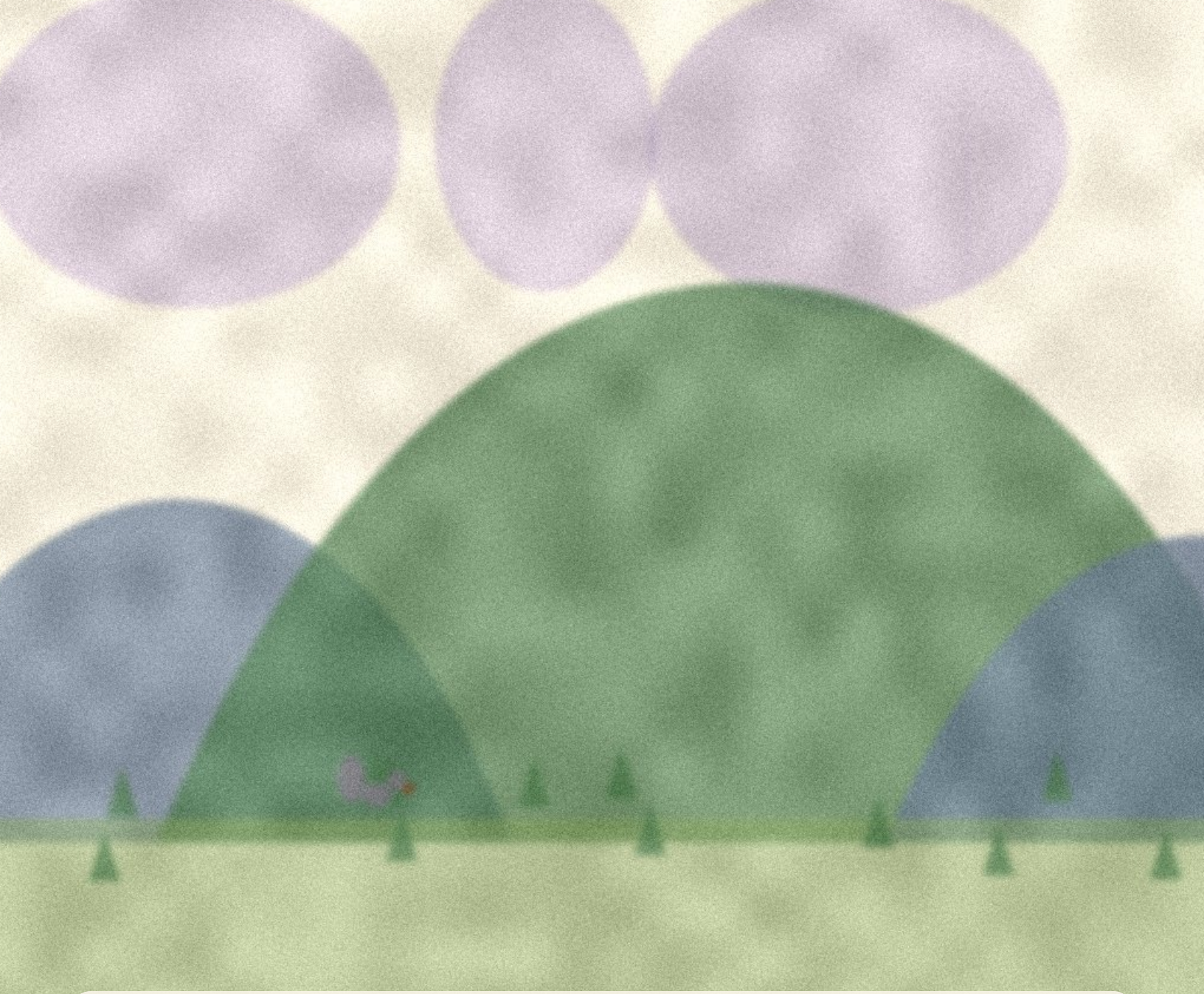
‘I was wrong to call you names,’ said Hunter Mountain. ‘I am sorry, Immy.’



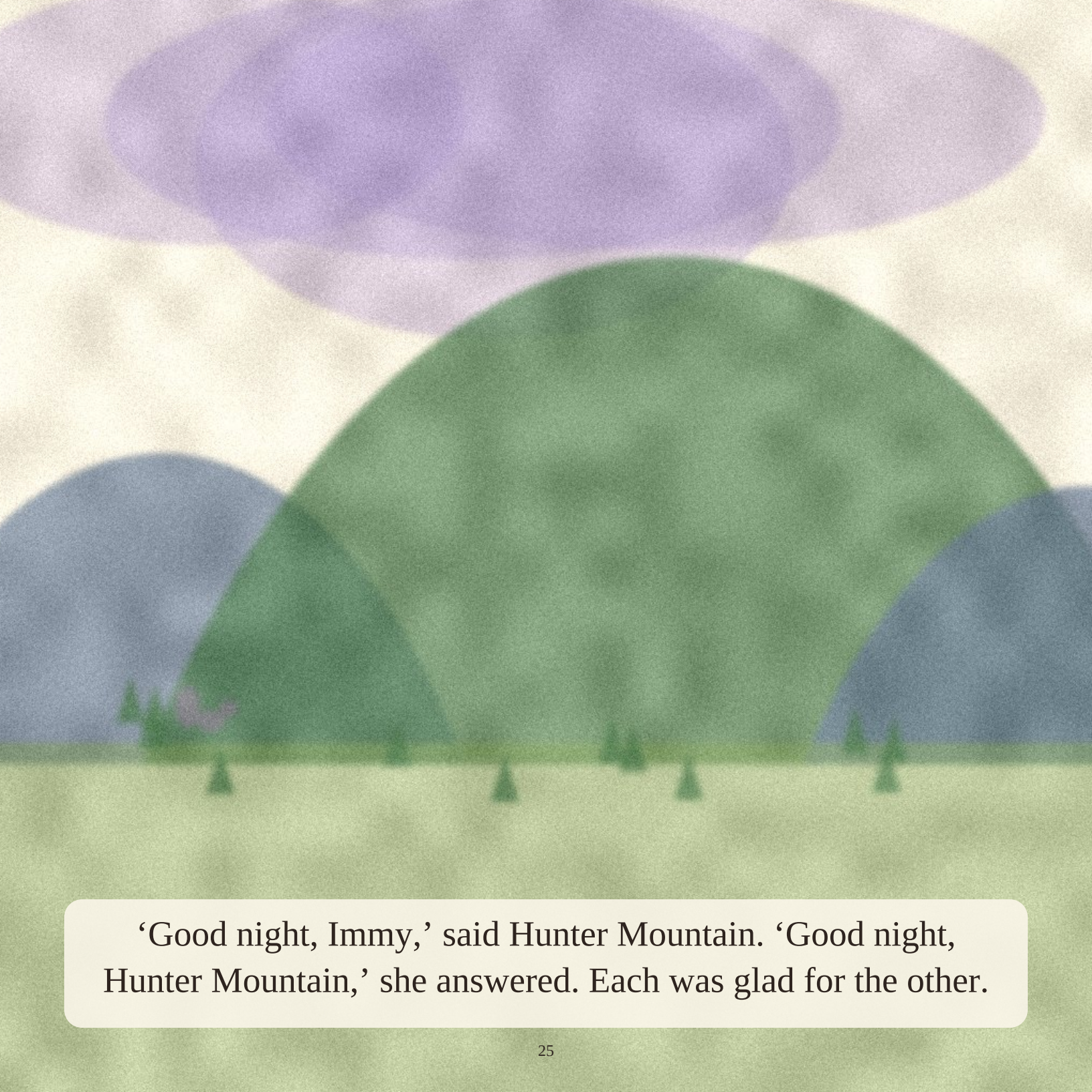
‘Thank you, Hunter Mountain,’ said Immy. ‘I like being your small neighbor.’



Hunter Mountain watched Immy spring from root to rock. So small—and able to do so much!



Hunter Mountain held the forest high. Immy tucked a nut beneath its leaves.



‘Good night, Immy,’ said Hunter Mountain. ‘Good night, Hunter Mountain,’ she answered. Each was glad for the other.

I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well.

Psalm 139:14 (BSB)

18 But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design. 19 If they were all one part, where would the body be? 20 As it is, there are many parts, but one body.

1 Corinthians 12:18-20 (BSB)

Fable

Ralph Waldo Emerson

Emerson’s original poem, from Poems (1847), later called “The Mountain and the Squirrel.” In it the squirrel is named Bun; in our retelling she is Immy.

The mountain and the squirrel
Had a quarrel;
And the former called the latter 'Little Prig.'
Bun replied,
'You are doubtless very big;
But all sorts of things and weather
Must be taken in together,
To make up a year
And a sphere.
And I think it no disgrace
To occupy my place.
If I'm not so large as you,
You are not so small as I,
And not half so spry.
I'll not deny you make
A very pretty squirrel track;
Talents differ; all is well and wisely put;
If I cannot carry forests on my back,
Neither can you crack a nut.'

Honoring God’s Good Design

A family devotional for Immy and Hunter Mountain: A Catskills Fable · © Martin Schoffstall

Scripture Reading

Psalm 139:14 (BSB) — I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well.

1 Corinthians 12:18-20 (BSB) — 18 But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design. 19 If they were all one part, where would the body be? 20 As it is, there are many parts, but one body.

The Big Idea

God made us with care. We honor His design when we thank Him for our gifts and value the gifts He gives others.

The Message

Hunter Mountain could carry a forest, but Immy could crack a nut! Being bigger did not make Hunter Mountain more important. Being smaller did not make Immy less valuable. Hunter Mountain needed to let go of pride, and Immy could be glad for how God made her. Each could appreciate the other's gifts.

Sometimes we boast about what we can do. Sometimes we feel small or wish we were someone else. God's Word helps us answer both feelings with gratitude. In the church, the Body of Christ, God gives His people different gifts so they can serve together. Just as our hands and feet do different jobs, we can help in different ways. We can thank God for our own gifts and cheer for someone else's!

Family Discussion Questions

1. Different Gifts — What could Immy do? What could Hunter Mountain do?

2. A Thankful Heart — What is something about the way God made you that you can thank Him for?

3. Enjoying Others' Gifts — When someone can do something you cannot, how can you encourage them?

4. Serving Together — What is one way our family can help someone this week?

Closing Prayer

Dear God, thank You for making us with care. Forgive us when we boast or forget that Your design is good. Help us use our gifts to serve, enjoy the gifts of others, and love one another as members of the Body of Christ. Amen.